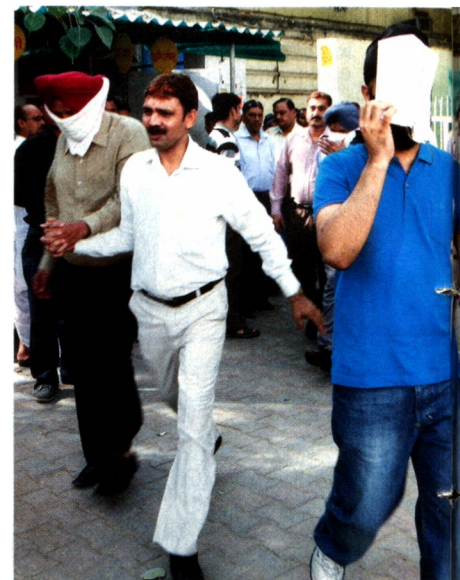


DOCTOR NO

Starting out as a physician at a government hospital in Ahmedabad, Desai consolidated his hold on the MCI

- 1993** Appointed **PRESIDENT** of the Gujarat Medical Council, a position Desai continues to hold till date.
- 1995-2000** **MEMBER** of the Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh, one of the premier medical institutes in the country.
- 1996** Elected for the first time as the **PRESIDENT** of the Medical Council of India, the regulatory body for the profession.
- 1996-1999** Serves as a **MEMBER** of the Governing Body of the Indian Council of Medical Research.
- 1999-2001** **MEMBER** of the institute body of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Delhi
- 1999** Appointed the **CHAIRMAN** of the Academic Committee of AIIMS, one of the most prestigious posts.
- Dec 2000** A prima facie case is established against him by the Income Tax Department after raids on his house unearth **RS 65 LAKH** in unaccounted cash.
- Aug 2001** **RENOMINATED** to several committees at AIIMS by Union Health Minister C.P. Thakur, even as the AIIMS Faculty Association's plea against his continuance is ignored.
- Nov 2001** **STEPS DOWN** as MCI president after Delhi High Court indicts him on corruption charges. Resigns from the position he held in AIIMS; the court also directs the CBI to investigate the case against him. FIR is registered a month later.
- Nov 2002** The Supreme Court directs the **CBI** to expeditiously deal with the matter and report to the designated court.
- Nov 2002** The **ADHOC COMMITTEE** appointed by the Supreme Court in 2002 is privy to the decisions being taken by the MCI which, however, remains unaware of the corruption revealed by the CBI.
- Oct 2004** Despite the report by income tax authorities, the CBI gives a **CLEAN CHIT** to Desai saying "no evidence came to light to show... Desai... granting undue favour in his official capacity".
- 2009** Elected again as **PRESIDENT** of the Medical Council of India and president-elect of the World Medical Association.
- April 22, 2010** **ARRESTED** by the CBI for allegedly striking a Rs 2-crore deal to grant recognition to a private medical college in Punjab. The MCI executive had earlier rejected the college's appeal; in raids held across Delhi, Punjab, Mumbai and Ahmedabad, CBI unearths details of moveable and immovable properties worth crores in the name of Desai and his family members. The MCI chief claims innocence, but a special court sends him to CBI custody. The agency claims what's unearthed is just the tip of the iceberg.



adverse report after which the executive council of the MCI would reject the application. Enter Desai, who would then renegotiate directly with the colleges and bail them out in his capacity as the MCI president by superseding the council's decision. Between November 2009 and March 2010 alone, Desai is said to have conducted about 125 inspections of various medical institutes across India.

Beginning as professor of urology at the Ahmedabad Civil Hospital, Desai first became the MCI chief in 1996 but stepped down in 2001 on the orders of the Delhi High Court after a prima facie case was established against him in December 2000. The Income Tax Department, which had raided his house, uncovered Rs 65 lakh. "These are accommodation transactions in the form of gifts and the alleged donors merely acted as conduits to channelise Desai's unaccounted money into his and his family members' accounts," Additional Director of Income Tax (Investigation) A. Bhaskar Reddy's report said. Desai also had to quit as chairman of the staff selection committee at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Delhi, and as a member of its institute body.

Desai's profile on the MCI website